UN Report Says U.S. Climate Pollution Went Up

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A new report from **United Nations** scientists says countries are not doing enough to cut **pollution** that warms the planet.

The report says the United States was the only big **economy** where this **pollution** went up a lot last year. Around the world, total **pollution** stayed about the same.

The report says U.S. **pollution** grew because people used more electricity and because of Trump **administration** rules that support burning coal, oil and gas. The U.S. government says it does not agree with the report.

When we burn coal, oil and gas, gases go into the air and trap heat. Earth is already about 2.7 degrees **Fahrenheit** warmer than in the mid-1800s.

The report says warming could stay below 3.6 degrees if **pollution** around the world drops by about 25% in the next ten years. Countries' current plans would cut it by only about 15%.

World leaders will meet in Turkey next month to talk about climate. The Trump **administration** will not go.

Word Treasure

United Nations -- A group where almost all the world's countries work together.

economy -- How a country makes and spends money, goods and services.

pollution -- Harmful stuff that gets into the air, water or land.

administration -- The president and the people who run the government with them.

Fahrenheit -- A scale used in the U.S. to measure temperature.

Background you need

When people burn coal, oil and gas for power and cars, gases go into the air and trap heat around Earth.

This makes the planet slowly warm up, which is called climate change.

Countries meet to make plans to cut this pollution.

Break it down

WHO: United Nations scientists and the Trump administration
WHAT: A report says U.S. planet-warming pollution went up a lot last year
WHERE: The United States, compared with other big economies around the world
WHY: More electricity use and rules that support burning coal, oil and gas

Why it matters

The air and weather we all share depend on how much pollution countries release.

Test what you remember

1. Who wrote the new report?

- (A) A car company
- (B) Turkey's leaders
- (C) A school class
- (D) United Nations scientists

2. What happened to U.S. climate pollution last year, according to the report?

- (A) It went down a lot
- (B) It went up a lot
- (C) It stayed the same
- (D) It stopped

3. What happens when we burn coal, oil and gas?

- (A) Gases go into the air and trap heat
- (B) The air gets colder
- (C) Nothing happens
- (D) It makes rain

4. How much warmer is Earth than in the mid-1800s?

- (A) Not warmer at all
- (B) About 25 degrees
- (C) About 2.7 degrees Fahrenheit
- (D) About 10 degrees

5. What does the U.S. government say about the report?

- (A) It wrote it
- (B) It agrees
- (C) It does not agree
- (D) It has not read it

6. Where will world leaders meet next month?

- (A) Canada
- (B) Turkey
- (C) Russia
- (D) China

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: B 3: A 4: C 5: C 6: B

Questions to think about

1. **UN report: Countries are not doing enough to cut pollution.**
2. **U.S. government: It does not agree with the report.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):